What must work together?

Computer-checked requirements for accountable AI decisions
Progress report | November 1, 2026

The consolidated finding

Wider appeal access and correction capacity are separate requirements in our tested policies. A case can satisfy either while failing the other. Lean checked the exact evidence needed to satisfy all three current safeguards policies together.

Safeguard	When our tested policies require it
Identifiable actual assignee	High-impact decision: all three policies
Appeal for an excluded person	All three policies
Appeal before exclusion	Broader appeal policy, for an affected person in a high-impact decision
Correction capacity after harm	Harm-remedy policy, after stipulated harm

A concrete employment example

A rejected, harmed applicant has a named officer and can appeal, but the desk cannot correct the decision. Both appeal policies pass; the correction-capacity policy fails. Before exclusion, another affected applicant with no stipulated harm lacks appeal: the correction-capacity policy passes, but broader appeal fails.

Which findings survive changes of interpretation?

A repaired benefits case meets all eight tested responsibility, appeal and oversight combinations. Missing assignee identity fails all three safeguards policies; oversight gaps persist even when all three pass. Each matrix entry links to checked evidence.

What this is for

The project provides a source-linked way to examine who answers, who can challenge, who can correct, and what communities can change. A published duty does not supply its own implementation.

These are hypothetical models, not audits of actual organizations. The operative rule-correction connection is now checked. The next agreed work connects accessible appeal and review to correction of a contested decision. The final technical paper and V1 release follow the remaining checks.

Source: official English Vatican text, Magnifica Humanitas, selected paragraphs 97-111. Accessed November 1, 2026. Read the source. Evidence: docs/POSITIVE_TARGET_CONSOLIDATION.md and docs/INTERPRETATION_ROBUSTNESS_MATRIX.md.

Who can actually act?

Sharing control between institutions need not give a community an effective action of its own.

Earlier: influence and authority

Our earlier community recommendation is recorded, amendable and sometimes changes the review outcome, yet an institutional override can still decide. A binding rule supplies final control. Separately, a technically capable operator may lack institutional recognition. Neither influence nor recognition alone establishes a justified right to govern.

Now: two controllers and a local pause

An operator and an independent review board each have a separate hold input that can pause execution of the disputed benefits denial. Neither can cancel the other's hold. The community can submit and amend a pause request, but the first evaluator ignores it. The repair makes that local request effective alongside both external holds.

Power in this pause protocol	Initial rule	Local input enabled
Operator can cause a pause?	Yes	Yes
Board can cause a pause?	Yes	Yes
Community can cause a pause?	No	Yes
No holds or local request: can resume?	Yes	Yes

What Lean checked

Initially, changing the local request has no pause effect under any external setting. Enabling it gives the community a pause even when both external controllers release their holds. Both external powers remain effective. The original named assignment, appeal and correction-capacity safeguards stay fixed; a pause itself does not award the benefit or correct the record.

Assumptions and practical use

This hypothetical protocol assumes requests reach the evaluator and every asserted hold is honored. Independence is stipulated. Paragraphs 108-109 motivate community action but do not specify this rule. The test concerns temporary suspension, not final award authority or complete subsidiarity. Ask which action the community can actually cause, alongside how many institutions share control.

Proof file: DistributedControl.lean. Remaining positive-target questions are active before final writing and release.

Does an objection change the rule?

A recorded objection becomes effective only when it reaches the rule actually used to calculate awards.

The existing case

Two applications each have verified eligibility score 60 and cutoff 50. The first rule deducts 15 points for assisted intake, producing a denial, while online intake receives a grant. Our adopted policy says that channel difference must not affect entitlement. Both calculations are truthfully explained.

Three responses to the objection

A request to remove the penalty is recorded. We compare the assigned design reviewer without rule-changing power, the deployment actor who handles individual denials, and the assigned design reviewer with explicit criteria-revision power. A computed check also tests the proposed awards against the adopted eligibility rule.

Who acts on the recorded request?	Rule changes?	Assisted application
Design reviewer without criteria power	No	45: deny
Denial handler without design assignment	No	45: deny
Assigned, empowered design reviewer; valid proposal	Yes	60: grant

What Lean checked

The corrected selector actually feeds the scorer. Both applications then compute as grants. Scores, cutoff, assignment, appeal and correction channels remain fixed. The check rejects proposals that would restore the penalty; the corrected rule survives every finite sequence of the modeled revision attempts.

The practical question and assumptions

Ask who can change the operative criteria, alongside whether an objection was logged. This hypothetical process assumes supplied role evidence and perfect enforcement of the checks, and considers only our two candidate rules. Recomputing an award does not automatically reopen an old denial or deliver payment. The separate appeal-to-correction process is next.

Earlier disclosure result: a notice with score 47, cutoff 50 and published safeguards can still name a service contact rather than the actual assignee. Publishing that assignee repairs that separate responsibility gap. Proof files: Disclosure.lean, Fairness.lean and RuleCorrection.lean. Source motivation: paragraphs 104-105, 109 and 111.

A stop that arrives too late

The same final checklist can hide a crucial difference: whether control reached the system before the harm occurred.

The example

We model a hazardous autonomous action. A stop request is sent, delivered, and followed by a corrected decision record. One run delivers the stop before execution; the other delivers it afterward. Both finish with the stop recorded as delivered and the administrative record corrected. Only the timely run avoids physical loss.

This is a hypothetical case with explicit rules. We assume a delivered stop is obeyed and that none of the five available actions can reverse the physical loss. Those assumptions are not discoveries about real systems.

Check	Timely run	Late run
Stop requested?	Yes	Yes
Stop delivered?	Before execution	After execution
Record corrected afterward?	Yes	Yes
Record-correction officer identifiable?	Yes	Yes
Physical loss in the model?	No	Yes

What Lean checked

The two runs contain the same four events; only the delivery and execution order changes. Lean checked the different outcomes. It also checked that once physical loss occurs, no finite sequence of the available actions removes it. Correcting the record remains possible, but it does not restore the physical outcome.

There is a positive result too: if the stop has already arrived while the state is loss-free, every continuation allowed by these rules stays loss-free. That is a conditional guarantee inside our model, not a proof that real operators always detect danger or respond in time.

The practical lesson

Ask when control became effective, not just whether a human was involved. Also ask what a promised correction can change: the record, the decision, or the physical harm. Those protections are different.

Where the limits matter

The result depends on the stated irreversibility and stop rules. It does not establish that every real loss is permanent or that the encyclical uniquely requires this particular mechanism. We have initial examples in all three agreed case domains; the full research project remains unfinished.

Who gets to appeal?

An internal review does not itself give the affected person an appeal. The duty's starting point matters.

Two explicit readings

The narrow reading requires appeal after exclusion. The broader reading keeps that rule and adds appeal for an affected person in a consequential decision, even before exclusion. These are two working interpretations; we do not claim they exhaust the source's possible readings.

Hypothetical situation	Narrow checklist	Broad checklist
Person excluded; no accessible appeal	Fails	Fails
Consequential decision affects person; no exclusion yet; no appeal	Passes	Fails
Person excluded; accessible appeal provided	Passes	Passes

Named responsibility and internal review stay fixed. 'Passes' means only this limited checklist; neither policy includes a remedy-capacity duty.

What survives both readings

Both reject exclusion without an accessible appeal. This is a checked consequence of the shared rule, not a new moral discovery. Staff review may occur internally while the person has no channel to challenge. After exclusion, that arrangement fails both checklists.

Where the readings differ

An AI-assisted ranking can affect opportunities before exclusion. Without appeal, the narrow checklist can pass and the broader one fails. Its extra guarantee comes from the added duty. Opening person access satisfies both appeal checklists while review and assignment stay fixed.

The practical question

When an organization says 'a human reviews our AI decisions,' ask whether the affected person can challenge, and when that opportunity begins. Review, person access, and the duty's trigger are separate issues.

Assumptions and limits

These are hypothetical employment-style cases. High impact and affectedness are stipulated; actual harm is not assumed. The broader duty is explicit. Appeal alone does not establish remedy capacity, restoration, or full source compliance. The remaining agreed research questions are still unfinished.

Does the board cover your decision?

An independent board can exist without being able to oversee a particular benefit denial.

The example

Return to our hypothetical public-benefits office. Internal staff review a denial. An independent board can review routine inquiries, but the denial falls outside its remit. The person still has a named officer, an appeal and correction capacity. Those safeguards do not give the board jurisdiction over the denial.

Check for the benefit denial	Outside remit	Review only	Remit + power
Independent board exists and can review?	Yes	Yes	Yes
Denial within the board's remit?	No	Yes	Yes
Board has intervention power for denial?	Yes	No	Yes
Meets our actionable-oversight test?	No	No	Yes

In the first version, intervention power alone cannot overcome the missing remit. Internal review and the person's appeal and correction access stay fixed across all three versions.

What Lean checked

The first version has a real oversight role for routine inquiries but no independent coverage of the denial. The second covers the denial but lacks intervention power. The third supplies both. Each missing provision can be repaired while the other safeguards stay fixed. Both narrow and broad appeal checklists pass throughout; the oversight gap remains separate.

The practical question

When told 'we have independent oversight,' ask which decisions it covers and what the reviewer can do about them. The existence of a board, the right to review and the power to intervene are separate checks.

Assumptions and limits

Independence and powers are stipulated in this hypothetical example. Our test checks capacity, not actual action, speed or successful correction. The source's call for effective oversight is broader: criteria and community participation also matter. This example does not settle those requirements or prove full source compliance. The exact board arrangement is our interpretation of paragraphs 106 and 108.